# Lesson 08 material: Reading a Tourism Website; Promotional Language

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 1: People and Places

## 2.1: Reading a Tourism Website: Welcome to East County

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

### Pre-Reading Activity

With your instructor or classmates, discuss a travel vacation you have taken in the past or a travel vacation you will take in the future. What activities do you enjoy the most when you travel for a vacation?

### Vocabulary Preview

Examine these photos. Do you know the words for these places and activities?

### Reading

Go to this website and read the tourism blurb.

### Reading Questions

**After you read, answer these questions to check your understanding.**

- What is the title of the web page? Where did you find the title?
- What location is the web page describing?
- Who might like to read this web page? (the audience)
  - Children in elementary school
  - Tourists who want to travel to Southern California
  - Immigrants who want to move to San Diego
  - Politicians who want to understand the problems in the area
- What is the purpose of the web page? In other words, what does the author want the reader to do?
  - Explain why East County is a good place to live
  - Give information about East County
  - Convince the reader to visit East County on vacation
  - Give the history of East County
- How did you decide the purpose of the web page? In other words, what parts of the page tell you its purpose?

### Understanding and Using Adjectives and Noun Modifiers

### Form: Adjective + Noun Combinations

**Identify the adjective + noun combinations in the following sentence.**

"*San Diego's East County wilderness is one of the most diverse areas in the county featuring rolling hills, majestic mountains, sparkling lakes, deep canyons, and desert landscapes plus Indian casino gaming*."

Adjectives: diverse, rolling, majestic, sparkling, deep, desert

Nouns: areas, hills, mountains, lakes, canyons, landscapes.

- What is the rule for adjective + noun word order?
  - DETERMINER + ADJECTIVE + NOUN
  - Examples: a sparkling lake, some rolling hills, the majestic mountains

### Form: Noun Modifiers

**In this sentence, which word tells us 'what kind of sports?'**

People use lakes for water sports.

Both the word ***water*** and the word ***sports*** are nouns. But ***water*** is telling us what kind of ***sports***.

In this phrase, ***sports*** is the head (or main) noun, and ***water*** is the noun modifier.

**Find the noun and noun modifier in this sentence.**

San Diego has many beautiful golf courses.

golf= noun modifier

courses= head noun

### Meaning: Adjectives and Noun Modifiers

**Read the two paragraphs below. Which paragraph is more interesting? Which paragraph makes you want to visit East County? Why? Discuss with your classmates and instructor.**

- In addition to outdoor adventures, East San Diego County boasts plenty of entertainment. Sizzling Las Vegas-style Native American casinos, luxurious resorts tucked right into the rugged landscape, challenging golf courses built around natural obstacles, historic sites and highways, and annual festivals and rodeos can be enjoyed, all within the expansive landscape of this California wilderness country.
- In addition to adventures, East San Diego County has entertainment. Casinos, resorts, golf courses, site and highways, and festivals and rodeos can be enjoyed, all within the landscape of this country.

**In the first paragraph above, identify the words that are missing in the second paragraph**

- Why do we use adjectives in a composition? Choose all that apply...
  - To add interesting details
  - To convince the reader that something is good or bad
  - To help the reader make a picture in their mind
  - Other (please specify)
- What is the usual word order for adjective and noun combinations?
  - (Article) + adjective + noun
  - (Article) + noun + adjective

### Vocabulary

### Descriptive Adjectives

Examine the text of "Welcome to East County." For each adjective in the first list, write the noun that follows. Then match the phrase in the first list with the words in the second list that show its meaning...

- Outdoor _____
- Luxurious _____
- Rugged _____
- Sharp _____
- Challenging _____
- Vast _____
- Diverse _____
- Natural _____
- Historic _____
- Annual _____
- Favorite _____
- Friendly _____

- Places that different a lot from each other
- A very big natural place
- A big and clear difference
- Fun activities outside
- Parties that happen every year in a town or city
- An area in nature like a mountain or forest that is wild and difficult to walk in
- A place to play the game of golf that is fun and difficult
- A village or place that has an interesting history
- A village where people smile and talk to each other
- A thing in nature that blocks the way
- A preferred journey to take for just a day
- Expensive and beautiful hotels

### Links on the original page

- these photos: https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1kznGWE3J71abhgpdUk9BfHMMcBQ091DiCEX01mM7MDU/edit#slide=id.p
- Web page (sandiego.org): https://www.sandiego.org/explore/inland-valley-mountain-desert/east-county.aspx

## 2.2: Writing: Promotional Language

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

**Use these activities to analyze and practice the promotional language in the tourist blurb "Welcome to East County."**

### This lesson is available as a worksheet.

Find the following phrases in the blurb "Welcome to East County" and highlight them. Then complete the sentences on this worksheet.

- The area offers _____
- Spend an afternoon _____
- Don't miss _____
- _____ is famous for _____

Write the grammatical structure that follows each of these phrases...

- The area offers + _____
- Spend an afternoon + _____
- Don't miss + _____
- _____ is famous for + _____

Write two sentences about each of the following places. Start each sentence with one of the four phrases above.

- Old Town, San Diego, CA
  - EX: Old Town offers shopping, historical sites, and great restaurants.
- Ocean Beach, CA
  - EX: Spend an afternoon surfing the waves, throwing a ball for your pooch at dog's beach, or sampling excellent vegan food at one of Ocean Beach's excellent cafes.
- Little Italy, San Diego, CA
  - Don't miss the weekly farmer's market every Saturday 8am - 2pm.

Look back at the "Welcome to East County" webpage. Are there any other phrases you could use in your own tourist blurb?

### Attribution

Worksheet created by Brittany Zemmlick, Grossmont College. Adapted by Sara Ferguson.

Photo credits

*Figure 1* *https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Old_town,_San_Diego,_CA,_USA.jpg*

*Figure 2* https://www.flickr.com/photos/michael-seljos/3627453311

*Figure 3* https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Little_Italy,_San_Diego.jpg

### Links on the original page

- Document (Google Docs): https://docs.google.com/document/d/1kBHUQBR8wfEsEYL8UnwPtsOs-71RXoobbQrzAWnRy3Y/edit?usp=sharing
- Welcome to East County: https://www.sandiego.org/explore/inland-valley-mountain-desert/east-county.aspx

## 2.3: Randall's Listening Lab: The Four Seasons

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

### Listening Activity

In this activity you will listen to a student speech about the seasons and check your understanding with comprehension questions.

### Pre-listening vocabulary

**Do you know these words? Put a check next to the words you know, and be prepared to tell or show your classmates their meaning.**

- Cold
- Hot
- Humid
- Dry
- Windy
- Pleasant
- Cool
- Snowy
- Breezy

### Listen to a Student Speech

**Listen to this recording and answer the questions that follow on the website. Then discuss or write the answers to the questions below.**

- What are the four seasons?
- What special outdoor activities do people like to do in your city in each of the four seasons? Use the suggested pattern.
  - In the _____, people like to _____.
  - EX: In the summer, people like to go surfing in the Pacific Ocean
  - Use the following vocabulary, and then add three words or phrases of your own...
  - Hike
  - Stroll
  - Fly kites
  - Picnic
  - Sledding
  - Visit _____
  - Sunbathe
  - Surf
  - _____
  - Some of these verbs can use the pattern "go" + _____-ing. Which ones? Example: go hiking

### Links on the original page

- Listening recording and questions (Randall's ESL Cyber Listening Lab): https://www.esl-lab.com/academic-english/four-seasons/